

Students should have an understanding of:

2.1	The call of the first disciples (Mark 1:14–20, 2:13–17): how this shows the nature of discipleship in showing the willingness to immediately follow Jesus regardless of consequence and how this might affect a Christian today; the sending out of the Twelve (Mark 6:7–13), how this shows the nature of discipleship, including the command to take nothing for the journey and the responsibility to preach and serve; divergent ways in which it affects ideas about Christian living today.
2.2	Parables: the Parable of the Tenants (Mark 12:1–12): how this story shows the potential cost of discipleship in and its relationship to Christians today; the Parable of the Sower (Mark 4:1–20), how each group shows different types of Christians; the nature of discipleship as shown in each group and in the role of the sower; its significance for Christians today; the importance of these parables with reference to the Kingdom of God and divergent ways in which that is variously understood as realised and in the future.
2.3	The story of the rich man (Mark 10:17–31): how this shows the nature of discipleship in the command to sell all things and how it will affect Christian discipleship today in different ways; its significance for Christians today with reference to the Kingdom of God and divergent ways in which that is variously understood as realised and in the future.
2.4	The spirit cast out of the boy (Mark 9:14–29): the problems of discipleship as shown in the efforts to cure the boy, and its significance for Christians today.
2.5	Jesus' teachings on service (Mark 10:41–45): the purpose of discipleship as shown in the command to serve; its implications and significance for Christians today.
2.6	Peter's denial (Mark 14:66–72): the challenges that the denial brings and what it teaches about the problems of discipleship, and its significance for Christians today as an example and warning; Christian responses to non-religious arguments (including atheist and Humanist) which suggest that religious observance, such as discipleship, can be seen to be unnecessary.
2.7	Women in the ministry of Jesus as shown in Mark's Gospel: the discipleship and importance of women, including the Greek woman (Mark 7:25–30); the anointing at Bethany (Mark 14:3–9); the crucifixion, burial and resurrection (Mark 15:40–47, 16:1–11); divergent understandings of its significance for Christians today.
2.8	Discipleship in the 21st century: divergent understandings of how discipleship is shown in the lives of individual Christians today; specific examples should show how a person's life reflects on the demands of discipleship outlined in Mark's Gospel, including Mark 8:34 and the examples of either Dietrich Bonhoeffer, Oscar Romero or Mother Teresa.

Overview

The textual studies section for Islam refers specifically to the Qur'an.

There are two sections: Beliefs and Teachings of Islam; Lives of the Prophets and Others.

The themes and teachings of the Qur'an are explored in depth; the references within the specification should be used as a starting point in a student's textual studies and students may use other texts from the Qur'an, Hadith and other holy books within Islam to help contextualise, understand and compare the teachings and examples found below. The exploration of the lives of the prophets, and others, should recognise that these stories teach spiritual truths in addition to being stories.

Students will be expected to study Islam and the Qur'an within the context of wider British society, the religious traditions of which are, in the main, Christian. Students should recognise that Islam is one of the many religions and world views in Great Britain, which include Buddhism, Hinduism, Judaism, Sikhism and non-religious views such as Humanism and atheism. This knowledge may be applied throughout the assessment of the specified content.

Students should compare and contrast the areas of belief and practice within Islam with non-religious views.

The significance and importance of the various beliefs, issues and practices of Muslims today should be explored throughout the two sections. They should understand how varied interpretations of the meaning of passages from the Qur'an may give rise to diversity within Muslim traditions and consider how far Muslim and non-religious communities give authority to the Qur'an, especially in relation to other sources of contemporary authority.